living conditions, at least in some slums, the solution has to be found in the roots of the problem.

First, the government and local bodies must recognize that clearance of slums is neither feasible nor necessary. Second, the entire land of the government and local bodies occupied under slums, minus what is required to create minimum infrastructure for utilities, should be, as a policy, used to create affordable housing, mostly rental housing, for migrants. Third, slum lands, excluding the utilities infrastructure land, should be auctioned to cooperatives of slumdwellers and private developers to primarily develop rental housing for migrants. As rental housing would be developed in higher rise buildings, which a liberal policy should allow, existing inhabitants should be able to get rental housing. The proceeds of the auction can be used for infrastructure creation and providing cash support for slumdwellers.

Slums cannot be wished away. They are the result of a particular set of policies followed. However, a different set of polices can convert slums into inhabitable and healthier places to live and work. Slumdwellers provide significant services to the inhabitants of cities. They can serve the cities better if they live in comfortable and hygienic conditions.

Labour Reforms

Labour Reforms Should Address the Real Labour Issues of the Day and Times to Come

The labour laws in force and the policies the Indian government pursues today are based on the industrial situation prevalent in the early stages of industrialization. These laws and policies have not taken into account the massive changes in the situation of labour that have been taking place over the past couple of decades.

There are three mega trends impacting labour as a factor of production: